



Privacy Policy

MUSIC RECOMMENDATION APP PROJECT

Introduction

This document outlines the approach taken to ensure data privacy and protection in the design and implementation of our academic music recommendation system. Although not a commercial product, the project applies best practices and principles inspired by leading data protection regulations such as the GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) and local privacy laws. Our goal is to build user trust, promote ethical data handling, and demonstrate responsible development in educational technology systems.

Data Collected

Our system is designed to work with a minimal set of data to personalize music recommendations while protecting user anonymity.

Types of data collected include:

- Musical preferences: liked genres, listened tracks, and user ratings.
- Session data: anonymous session ID for tracking preferences without personal identification.
- Interaction data: click and navigation behavior for improving system accuracy (optional and anonymized).

The system explicitly avoids collecting:

- Personally identifiable information (PII) such as names, emails, phone numbers, or addresses.
- Sensitive data such as age, location, or financial detail

Data Minimization and Anonymization Techniques

In alignment with privacy-first principles, we apply the following practices:

- ****Minimization****: Only necessary data is collected, stored, and used.

- **Pseudonymization**: Each user is assigned a random, non-traceable identifier.
- **Anonymization**: No data points can be traced back to real users. The data is processed in bulk where possible to avoid individual profiling.

These methods help reduce the risks associated with data breaches and unauthorized access

Data Storage and Security Measures

Data is stored using secure methods and systems to prevent unauthorized access, loss, or corruption:

- The backend database is protected with hashed admin credentials and access controls.
- Data transfer between components is encrypted using HTTPS and secure protocols.
- No user data is cached in unsecured browser storage or temporary logs.

Regular backups and test restores are conducted to ensure availability and integrity.

Compliance with Ethical and Legal Standards

While this academic project is not governed by actual law, it voluntarily complies with key principles of major data protection frameworks such as:

- **GDPR**: Transparency, accountability, data minimization, integrity, and confidentiality.
- **User Rights Simulation**: The right to access data, modify preferences, and request deletion of information.

We are committed to complying with all applicable ethical and legal standards, including:

- **GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation)**: Ensuring compliance with GDPR requirements for users within the European Economic Area (EEA).
- **CCPA (California Consumer Privacy Act)**: Complying with CCPA regulations for California residents.
- **Transparency and Fairness**: Being transparent about our data practices and ensuring fairness in how we use your data.

User Consent and Transparency

User consent is a cornerstone of data ethics. Our system includes a mock consent step to simulate real user agreement before any data is collected.

The system interface explains:

- What data is collected
- Why it is collected
- How it will be used

Though purely for educational use, this consent simulation raises awareness about informed decisions in data-driven applications

Future Improvements

For future iterations or possible deployment in real environments, the following improvements are considered:

- Full privacy policy documentation integrated in-app.
- Role-based access control (RBAC) for system administrators.
- Real-time data deletion tools for users.
- Enhanced encryption at rest and in transit.
- Transparency reports that describe how and why user data is processed.

These additions would improve accountability and allow the project to evolve into a responsible production-level service.

User Rights

You have the following rights regarding your data:

- Access: You have the right to access your personal data.
- Rectification: You have the right to correct inaccurate or incomplete data.
- Erasure: You have the right to request the deletion of your data.
- Objection: You have the right to object to the processing of your data.
- Restriction: You have the right to restrict the processing of your data.
- Data Portability: You have the right to receive your data in a portable format.

To exercise these rights, please contact us using the contact information below.

Contact Information

This document demonstrates that even in academic or prototype systems, implementing good data privacy and protection practices is not only possible but encouraged. With a minimalistic, ethical-first

approach, the music recommendation system respects user autonomy and offers a responsible data experience, setting a foundation for scalable and privacy-aware technology development

Summary

This Privacy Policy outlines our commitment to protecting your privacy while providing personalized music recommendations. We collect only necessary data, implement robust security measures, and comply with applicable legal and ethical standards. You have rights regarding your data and can contact us with any questions or concerns.